

PRINTABLE TEACHER PACK

CLASSROOM WARM-UP GAMES PACK

10 five-minute games to energize the room, activate English, and start class with confidence.

10

GAMES

5

MINUTES

A1-B1

LEVELS

Includes materials, step-by-step instructions, prompts, and classroom tips.

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CHOOSE YOUR WARM-UP

Pick by language focus, energy level, and preparation time.

NO.	GAME	FOCUS	LEVEL	ENERGY	PREP
1	Rapid Word Chain	Vocabulary recall	A1-B1	Medium	No prep
2	Stand Up If...	Listening	A1-A2	High	No prep
3	This Or That	Speaking choices	A1-B1	High	Low prep
4	Hot Seat	Describing words	A2-B1	High	Low prep
5	Category Countdown	Vocabulary groups	A1-B1	Medium	No prep
6	Mystery Object	Yes/no questions	A1-A2	Medium	Low prep
7	Two Truths & One Fib	Listening for details	A2-B1	Low	No prep
8	Pass The Question	Quick responses	A1-B1	High	Low prep
9	Find Someone Who...	Question practice	A1-B1	High	Low prep
10	5-Second Challenge	Fluency	A1-B1	High	No prep

THE 5-MINUTE FORMULA

0:00-0:30

Explain

0:30-4:30

Play

4:30-5:00

Praise + bridge to lesson

READY, SET, WARM UP!

Keep instructions short, model one example, and stop while the energy is still high.

1

RAPID WORD CHAIN

A1-B1

MEDIUM

NO PREP

GOAL

Activate familiar vocabulary and train quick listening.

MATERIALS None

HOW TO PLAY

1. Choose one category, such as food, jobs, or classroom objects.
2. Student 1 says one word. The next student adds a different word within three seconds.
3. Continue for one minute, then restart with a new category. Repeated words do not score.

TRY THIS

Category: food -> rice, bread, soup, noodles...

TEACHER TIP

For a harder round, each new word must begin with the final letter of the previous word.

2

STAND UP IF...

A1-A2

HIGH

NO PREP

GOAL

Wake up the class while reviewing simple statements and questions.

MATERIALS None

HOW TO PLAY

1. Students begin seated. Say a safe statement beginning with 'Stand up if...'.
2. Students stand when the statement is true for them, then sit again.
3. Use five to seven statements. Invite two students to create the final prompts.

TRY THIS

Stand up if you like noodles / have a blue pen / walked to school.

TEACHER TIP

Use hand signals instead of standing when space is limited. Avoid sensitive or private prompts.

READY, SET, WARM UP!

Keep instructions short, model one example, and stop while the energy is still high.

3

THIS OR THAT

A1-B1

HIGH

LOW PREP

GOAL

Build confidence in giving short opinions.

MATERIALS Two choice signs (optional)

HOW TO PLAY

1. Label two sides of the room with two choices, or assign two hand signals.
2. Say a pair of choices. Students move or show their chosen signal.
3. Ask one student from each choice to explain using 'I prefer... because...'.

TRY THIS

Morning or night? Books or movies? Study alone or with friends?

TEACHER TIP

Keep the pace fast: three choices and only two short explanations per round.

4

HOT SEAT

A2-B1

HIGH

LOW PREP

GOAL

Review vocabulary through definitions, clues, and teamwork.

MATERIALS Board or vocabulary cards

HOW TO PLAY

1. Divide the class into two teams. One player sits facing the class, away from the board.
2. Write or show a target word. Teammates describe it without saying the word or translating it.
3. Give each team 45 seconds. Rotate players and complete two rounds.

TRY THIS

Target: umbrella -> You use it when it rains.

TEACHER TIP

Prepare words from the previous lesson so the game also works as quick retrieval practice.

READY, SET, WARM UP!

Keep instructions short, model one example, and stop while the energy is still high.

5

CATEGORY COUNTDOWN

A1-B1

MEDIUM

NO PREP

GOAL

Recall several words from one topic under a short time limit.

MATERIALS Board or scrap paper

HOW TO PLAY

1. Put students in small teams and announce one category.
2. Teams have 30 seconds to write five correct words in that category.
3. Check answers quickly. Give one point for each correct, non-repeated word. Play three rounds.

TRY THIS

Write five: school subjects / adjectives / things in a kitchen.

TEACHER TIP

For speaking-only classes, teams say their answers instead of writing them.

6

MYSTERY OBJECT

A1-A2

MEDIUM

LOW PREP

GOAL

Practice question forms and descriptive vocabulary.

MATERIALS One object and a bag/box

HOW TO PLAY

1. Hide a familiar classroom object inside a bag or behind your back.
2. Students ask yes/no questions. Answer only yes, no, or sometimes.
3. After five questions, allow guesses. Reveal the object and repeat once if time remains.

TRY THIS

Is it made of plastic? Do we use it for writing? Is it small?

TEACHER TIP

Use objects learners already know: marker, ruler, notebook, eraser, or key.

READY, SET, WARM UP!

Keep instructions short, model one example, and stop while the energy is still high.

7

TWO TRUTHS & ONE FIB

A2-B1

LOW

NO PREP

GOAL

Encourage short personal speaking in a playful, low-pressure format.

MATERIALS

None

HOW TO PLAY

1. Model three safe statements about yourself: two true and one invented.
2. Students vote for the statement they think is the fib and explain one clue.
3. Invite two or three students to share their own sets. Keep each turn under one minute.

TRY THIS

I can cook noodles. I have visited Bali. I speak five languages.

TEACHER TIP

Students may use hobbies, food, school, or travel. Never require private information.

8

PASS THE QUESTION

A1-B1

HIGH

LOW PREP

GOAL

Get many learners answering short questions without long turn-taking.

MATERIALS

Soft ball or crumpled paper

HOW TO PLAY

1. Students pass a soft object hand-to-hand while the class counts from one to ten.
2. Say 'stop'. The holder answers one short review question.
3. Restart immediately and play six to eight fast rounds. No student is eliminated.

TRY THIS

What did you do yesterday? Name three animals. What time do you wake up?

TEACHER TIP

Use a paper ball and hand-to-hand passing only; do not throw objects across the room.

READY, SET, WARM UP!

Keep instructions short, model one example, and stop while the energy is still high.

9

FIND SOMEONE WHO...

A1-B1

HIGH

LOW PREP

GOAL

Practice asking classmates questions for real information.

MATERIALS Three prompts on paper or board

HOW TO PLAY

1. Display three prompts and model the matching question for each one.
2. Students speak to three classmates and write one name beside each prompt.
3. After three minutes, ask for two quick reports using 'I found someone who...'.

TRY THIS

Find someone who likes cats / woke up before 6 / can play an instrument.

TEACHER TIP

One name per prompt keeps the activity moving and prevents long conversations.

10

5-SECOND CHALLENGE

A1-B1

HIGH

NO PREP

GOAL

Build speed and confidence when retrieving familiar language.

MATERIALS Timer (optional)

HOW TO PLAY

1. Give one student a 'Name three...' challenge and count down from five.
2. Accept any three correct answers. If the student needs help, the class may add one answer.
3. Move quickly to a new student and topic. Complete eight to ten turns with no elimination.

TRY THIS

Name three fruits / verbs / classroom rules / weekend activities.

TEACHER TIP

Use topics already studied. The goal is quick recall, not trick questions.